

Toddler Biting Daycare Crisis — Action Checklist

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UNDERSTAND BITING IS NOT MALICIOUS

- ❑ **Understand Biting Is Not Malicious:** Reframe biting as a communication attempt rather than aggressive behavior because your child lacks the words to express frustration, overstimulation, or fear and is using biting as their voice.
- ❑ **Understand Biting Is Not Malicious:** Accept that this behavior reflects your child's developmental stage, not your parenting failures, because the American Academy of Pediatrics confirms that biting peaks between 18 and 24 months when emotions outpace verbal skills.
- ❑ **Understand Biting Is Not Malicious:** Remember that your toddler cannot always control impulses in the moment because the prefrontal cortex does not fully develop until ages 3 to 4, making this a physical brain development issue.
- ❑ **Understand Biting Is Not Malicious:** Shift your focus from punishing the behavior to identifying its causes because biting has specific triggers that can be addressed once understood rather than simply suppressed.

IDENTIFY YOUR CHILD'S BITING TYPE

- ❑ **Identify Your Child's Biting Type:** Watch for frustration biting by noting if incidents occur during transitions, after being told no, or when another child takes a toy, since this is the most common type at daycare.
- ❑ **Identify Your Child's Biting Type:** Look for sensory biting signs such as chewing on non-food objects, crib rails, or toys even when content, which may indicate your child's nervous system needs additional sensory input.
- ❑ **Identify Your Child's Biting Type:** Monitor for impulse biting by checking if biting happens without warning, your child seems surprised by their own behavior afterward, or biting occurs during both high excitement and high frustration.
- ❑ **Identify Your Child's Biting Type:** Distinguish attention biting by noting if it happens when you look away, serves to provoke a reaction, or intensifies when your response is dramatic rather than calm.

RULE OUT MEDICAL TRIGGERS FIRST

- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Triggers First:** Check for teething by watching for drooling, gum swelling, new nighttime waking, and increased chewing on hard objects since molars and canines cause significant pain between 18 and 24 months.

 - ☐ **Rule Out Medical Triggers First:** Look for ear infection signs including ear pulling, fluid draining from ears, increased irritability following a cold, disturbed sleep, and fever since toddlers cannot tell you their ear hurts.

 - ☐ **Rule Out Medical Triggers First:** Investigate constipation by noting straining, hard pellet stools, potty refusal, and abdominal bloating because abdominal discomfort from constipation dramatically lowers frustration tolerance and is frequently overlooked.

 - ☐ **Rule Out Medical Triggers First:** Schedule a pediatrician visit if physical symptoms are present since addressing medical triggers first can resolve or significantly reduce biting without additional behavioral intervention.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.